

- **Presentación:**

Hello, I'm Nicolás García-Sampedro. I work as a Web Developer on Microsoft's website and I'm very interested in how technology affects our freedom and daily lives.

- **Parte 1 después de Alvaro:**

That sounds ideal, but it hides a dangerous dependency on technology. If everything is automated, what happens when something fails? A single cyberattack could cause chaos, stop public transport, or even lock people inside automated vehicles. We have seen how even small software errors can cause serious problems in real systems, as happened recently with Amazon Web Services, whose crash caused many websites and applications to be down for most of the day. Now imagine that at the scale of an entire city.

Also, automation comes with social consequences. Drivers, mechanics, and even public transport workers could lose their jobs. And as cities become more digital, they also become less private. Every trip, every location, every movement could be tracked. The idea of total connectivity might make life easier, but it also risks turning citizens into data points.

And we can't forget the human side of this. Think about the taxi driver who's been working for 20 years and suddenly sees his job replaced by an AI. Retraining sounds great in theory, but in practice, many workers don't have the chance or resources to adapt. We must make sure that progress doesn't leave people behind. And when something goes wrong; like a system outage or a blackout; who's responsible for the damage? A city this automated needs a backup plan that doesn't depend on algorithms.

- **Parte 2 después de la pregunta de Chao:**

Because it sounds like the perfect surveillance trap. Imagine cameras on every corner, sensors on every building, and algorithms analyzing everything we do. Governments and companies could track every movement, purchase, and interaction. Even if it's meant to improve efficiency, the data could easily be used for control, as is already happening in China, where citizens are monitored by facial recognition and social credit systems. Who guarantees it won't be misused? A perfectly organized city could easily become a perfectly controlled one.

And the biggest problem is that we wouldn't even notice it happening. Data is collected quietly, through devices we use every day; phones, smart watches, even our homes. Bit by bit, citizens could lose privacy until it becomes normal to live under constant observation. It's not just about being watched, it's about being predictable. When algorithms know your habits, they can manipulate them by recommending what you should buy, watch or even think. This is dangerous because freedom isn't just about movement; it's also about having the ability to make independent choices.

- **Parte 2 después de Jorge también:**

Maybe, but we could also lose something less visible: our cultural identity. Cities full of holograms and smart screens could look clean but soulless. Traditional markets, street art, human noise; all replaced by digital perfection. Even worse, like I said before, if the network collapses, everything could fall apart. Ironically, a city designed to protect nature could harm it because of the rare materials and massive energy needed to maintain all this technology.

- **Parte 3 después de Alvaro:**

That's a noble vision, but often what we see in practice is greenwashing; making things look sustainable when they're not. Corporations claim their tech is saving the planet while their factories pollute elsewhere. And culturally, it's easy to say tech helps art, but algorithms mostly promote what's popular, not what's meaningful. Futuristic cities could end up prioritizing profit and convenience over creativity and humanity.

That's why there should be transparency from start to finish. If a company claims their project is eco-friendly, they should prove it; show how materials are sourced, where they're made, and who benefits from them. And cities should invest not just in smart infrastructure but also in smart culture: supporting local artists, public art programs, and community events. Without that, the 'future' city might feel perfect but empty.

- **Parte 4 después de Alvaro:**

That's great in theory, but remote work can also make people feel lonely and disconnected. Cafes, restaurants, and small shops that depend on office workers could struggle. Also, 15-minute cities can raise property prices, making central areas unaffordable. And digital participation often feels symbolic; like pressing a button but not being truly heard.

To fix that, governments could encourage local coworking hubs and community events to bring people together again. Companies could even get small tax benefits if they support local spaces where employees can meet and collaborate. The goal shouldn't just be convenience; it should be community.

For example, in some European cities, local councils are creating hybrid spaces that combine technology and community; libraries that host coding workshops, or cafes where freelancers can collaborate. These initiatives show that we don't have to choose between digital progress and human connection. The future city should be both smart and social.

- **Closing después de Jorge:**

Exactly. A city full of automation isn't better if people feel isolated or constantly watched. True progress means preserving freedom, privacy, and humanity.